

Purpose: To help us learn to apply in our own lives, the instructions, the Lord has revealed to others in the scriptures.

1 Nephi 19:23 How did Nephi make so much progress?

“Elder Jay E. Jensen described a time when he was serving as a mission president and found himself frustrated and discouraged at the end of a district conference by the many problems that confronted him. As he was traveling home, he was turning the pages of his scriptures, looking for comfort and direction, when he stopped at the third section of the Doctrine and Covenants. He said:

“When I read a verse, I often insert my name in it. I did so with verse 5 and found the help I needed to remove my gloomy feelings: ‘Behold, you [Jay Jensen] have been entrusted with these things, but how strict were your commandments; and remember also the promises which were made to you [Jay Jensen]’ (D&C 3:5).

“The words ‘remember also the promises’ struck me with unusual power.... During those four days I had focused on nothing but problems. I had not stopped to consider one single promise.” (Jay E. Jensen, “[Remember Also the Promises](#),” Ensign, Nov. 1992, 80; emphasis added. In Lesson Manual.)

Practice: Imagine the Lord calls you by your [first name] and speaks the scripture to you personally.

1. Husbands and wives should support and comfort each other.

“[M]any of the revelations given in the Doctrine and Covenants were given to individuals. [However], much of this counsel applies to us today. The Lord ... said, ‘What I say unto one I say unto all.’ (D&C 61:36; 82:5; 93:49)” (LM) D&C 25:5 **1.†** The Prophet Joseph Smith **2.†** The Prophet Joseph Smith **3.†** LaMar C. Berrett D&C 25:14

How can spouses increase their delight in each other?

The Prophet Joseph Smith wrote this in 1842 after Emma visited him while he was in hiding because his life was in danger: “With what unspeakable delight, and what transports of joy swelled my bosom, when I took by the hand, on that night, my beloved Emma—she that was my wife, even the wife of my youth, and the choice of my heart. Many were the reverberations of my mind when I contemplated for a moment the many scenes we had been called to pass through, the fatigues and the toils, the sorrows and sufferings, the joys and consolations, from time to time, which had strewed our paths.... Oh what a commingling of thought filled my mind for the moment, again she is here,... undaunted, firm, and unwavering—unchangeable, affectionate Emma!” (History of the Church, 5:107)

4.† Lucy Mack Smith

What can we learn from the examples of Joseph and Emma to better support our spouses?

2. We should be meek and avoid pride.

D&C 25:14 “beware of pride” D&C 23:1; 38:39; 90:17; 98:19-20

5.† President Ezra Taft Benson

How can we overcome pride and cultivate a spirit of meekness?

6.† President Ezra Taft Benson

D&C 1:28, 19:23, 112:10; 124:97

What are some blessings of Humility?

3. We should rejoice and be of good cheer.

D&C 25:13 “Lift up thy heart and rejoice”

D&C 29:5; 61:36; 68:6; 78:18; 136:29

Why strive to be of good cheer?

How can we develop and maintain good cheer?

How can we help others to be of good cheer?

7.† Elder Marvin J. Ashton

Next Week: Lesson 11: “The Field Is White Already to Harvest”; See L11 [Class Member Study Guide](#).

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(You can download a free LDS Institute Manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325.](#))

1.† The Prophet Joseph Smith: Wives should treat their husbands “with mildness and affection. When a man is borne down with trouble, when he is perplexed with care and difficulty, if he can meet a smile instead of an argument or a murmur—if he can meet with mildness, it will calm down his soul and soothe his feelings.” (*Teachings of the Prophet Joseph Smith*, sel. Joseph Fielding Smith [1976], 228)

2.† The Prophet Joseph Smith: “It is the duty of a husband to love, cherish, and nourish his wife, and cleave unto her and none else; he ought to honor her as himself, and he ought to regard her feelings with tenderness.” (*Elders’ Journal*, Aug. 1838, 61)

3.† LaMar C. Berrett: “When Emma was ill, Joseph took personal care of her. Perhaps he could have hired nurse Jane Johnson to take care of Emma. Or perhaps his mother could have taken care of her; but Joseph’s journal entries indicate that he played the role of nurse himself, and this at a time when he was, as usual, extremely busy. Joseph’s writings further attest to his love and care for Emma: ‘Emma began to be sick with fever; consequently I kept in the house with her all day.’ ‘Emma is no better. I was with her all day.’ ‘Emma was a little better. I was with her all day.’ The entries go on and on. He spent much time with Emma when she was ill, caring for his wife tenderly and lovingly. Mercy Thompson said, ‘I saw him [Joseph] by the bed-side of Emma, his wife, in sickness, exhibiting all the solicitude and sympathy possible for the tenderest of hearts and the most affectionate of natures to feel’.” (*The Prophet Joseph Smith: Essays on the Life and Mission of Joseph Smith*, 43)

4.† Lucy Mack Smith: “I have never seen a woman in my life, who would endure every species of fatigue and hardship, from month to month, and from year to year, with that unflinching courage, zeal, and patience, which she has ever done; for I know that which he had had to endure.... She has breasted the storms of persecution, and buffeted the rage of men and devils, which would have borne down almost any other woman.” (*History of the Prophet Joseph Smith*, ed. Preston Nibley [1958], 190-91)

5.† President Ezra Taft Benson: “Most of us think of pride as self-centeredness, conceit, boastfulness, arrogance, or haughtiness. All of these are elements of the sin, but the heart, or core, is still missing.

“The central feature of pride is enmity—enmity toward God and enmity toward our fellowmen. *Enmity* means ‘hatred toward, hostility to, or a state of opposition.’

“Pride is essentially competitive in nature. We pit our will against God ... in the spirit of ‘my will and not

thine be done.’ ... The proud cannot accept the authority of God giving direction to their lives. (See Hel. 12:6) They pit their perceptions of truth against God’s great knowledge, their abilities versus God’s priesthood power, their accomplishments against His mighty works.

“Our enmity toward God takes on many labels, such as rebellion, hardheartedness, stiffneckedness, unrepentant, puffed up, easily offended, and sign seekers. The proud wish God would agree with them. They aren’t interested in changing their opinions to agree with God’s.

“Another major portion of this very prevalent sin of pride is enmity toward our fellowmen. We are tempted daily to elevate ourselves above others and diminish them (see Hel. 6:17; D&C 58:41).... It is manifest in so many ways, such as fault-finding, gossiping, backbiting, murmuring, living beyond our means, envying, coveting, withholding gratitude and praise that might lift another, and being unforgiving and jealous....

“Selfishness is one of the more common faces of pride. ‘How everything affects me’ is the center of all that matters—self-conceit, self-pity, worldly self-fulfillment, self-gratification, and self-seeking....

“Another face of pride is contention. Arguments, fights, unrighteous dominion, generation gaps, divorces, spouse abuse, riots, and disturbances all fall into this category of pride....” (“Beware of Pride,” *Ensign*, May 1989, 4-6; emphasis added)

6.† President Ezra Taft Benson: “The antidote for pride is humility—meekness, submissiveness (see Alma 7:23). It is the broken heart and contrite spirit.... We can choose to humble ourselves by loving God, submitting our will to His, and putting Him first in our lives.” (“Beware of Pride,” *Ensign*, May 1989, 6-7)

7.† Elder Marvin J. Ashton: “None of us will escape tragedy and suffering. Each of us will probably react differently. However, if we can recall the Lord’s promise, ‘for I the Lord am with you,’ we will be able to face our problems with dignity and courage. We will find the strength to be of good cheer instead of becoming resentful, critical, or defeated. We will be able to meet life’s unpleasant happenings with clear vision, strength, and power....

“What a joy it is to see someone of good cheer, who, when others because of an unpleasant happening or development live in angry silence or vocal disgust, meets the situation with cheerful endurance and good spirits.” (“Be of Good Cheer,” *Ensign*, May 1986, 66)